

Module 00

VS Code Optional

COURSE	AI Workshop 2.0, Desktop Edition
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YOU NEED	A Mac or PC and a paid Claude plan

WHY -- Why This Matters

Before you can use AI tools, you need a workspace that's set up properly. VS Code is that workspace. GitHub Copilot is the tool that sets it up for you.

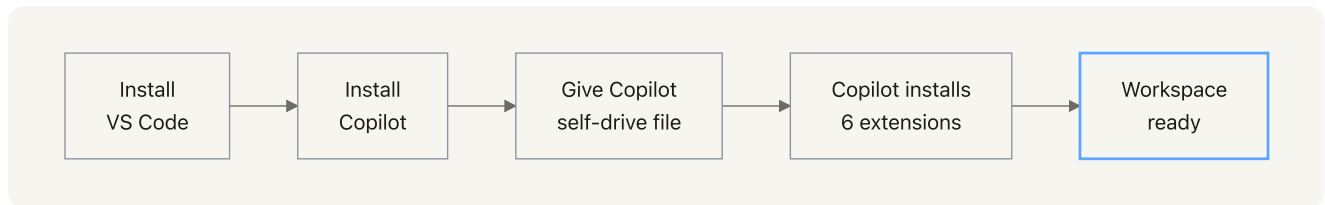
Important framing: Copilot is your **setup tool**. It installs extensions, configures your theme, and gets VS Code ready. From Module 1 onwards, **Claude Code CLI** is the main tool you'll use for building.

Think of it this way:

- **Copilot** = The person who sets up your desk on day one
- **Claude Code** = The colleague who works alongside you every day

WHAT -- What You'll Learn

How to use Copilot to configure a complete AI-powered workspace in under 10 minutes.



The 6 Extensions (hardcoded -- no more, no less)

#	EXTENSION ID	WHAT IT DOES
1	<code>github.copilot</code>	AI coding assistant (free tier: 100 tasks/month)
2	<code>github.copilot-chat</code>	Copilot chat panel inside VS Code
3	<code>anthropic.claude-code</code>	Claude Code -- the main AI tool from Module 1
4	<code>akamud.vscode-theme-onedark</code>	One Dark theme (easy on the eyes)
5	<code>cweijan.vscode-office</code>	View PDFs, markdown (WYSIWYG), and xlsx files
6	<code>yzhang.markdown-all-in-one</code>	Markdown shortcuts + table of contents

What You Need Before Starting

- VS Code installed (free from code.visualstudio.com)
- A GitHub account (free)
- Internet connection

HOW -- The Self-Drive Process

Same cycle as every module:

- 1. **You read** this README (done)
- 2. **You give Copilot the self-drive file** -- open `COPILLOT-SELF-DRIVE.md` , copy the contents, paste into Copilot Chat
- 3. **Copilot builds** -- it installs all 6 extensions, sets your theme, and verifies everything works

Making VS Code Feel Like Home

Once Copilot finishes the setup, these four tweaks make VS Code feel less like a code editor:

- 1. **Theme** -- One Dark is already installed. If you want something different, Command Palette (Cmd+Shift+P) -> "Color Theme"
- 2. **File icons** -- The Office extension gives you familiar icons for PDFs, spreadsheets, etc.
- 3. **Sidebar** -- Pin your project folder in the Explorer. Hide panels you don't use
- 4. **Font size** -- Cmd+Plus (Mac) / Ctrl+Plus (Windows) to zoom in until it feels comfortable

When it's personalised, it stops feeling like software and starts feeling like home.

Quick Reference

WHAT	WHERE
Copilot Chat	Sidebar: Cmd+Shift+I (Mac) / Ctrl+Shift+I (Windows)
Command Palette	Cmd+Shift+P (Mac) / Ctrl+Shift+P (Windows)
Settings	Cmd+, (Mac) / Ctrl+, (Windows)
Agent Mode	Switch in Copilot chat dropdown menu

Troubleshooting

PROBLEM	FIX
Copilot won't install	Update VS Code to latest version, check GitHub sign-in

PROBLEM	FIX
Can't authenticate	Click "Sign in" when prompted, approve in browser, return to VS Code
Extensions not appearing	Make sure you're in Agent mode, restart VS Code
Also see COPILOT-CHEATSHEET.pdf in this folder for a full troubleshooting guide.	

WHAT IF -- What This Unlocks

Your workspace is now ready for the real work. From here:

- **Module 000** -- Install Claude Code CLI (the tool that does the heavy lifting)
- **Module 1** -- Create your `CLAUDE.md` file (custom instructions for Claude Code)
- **Module 2** -- Set up a Master Log (session continuity)
- **Module 3** -- Slash commands, skills, and Plan Mode (speed and control)
- **Module 4** -- MCPs (connect Claude to external services)
- **Module 5** -- AI agents (autonomous specialists)

Copilot stays available for quick tasks, but Claude Code is where the power is.

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